

SENATE No. 2500

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

John C. Velis

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to recognition of the "Honor and Remember" flag in the Commonwealth.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>John C. Velis</i>	<i>Hampden and Hampshire</i>	
<i>Hannah Kane</i>	<i>11th Worcester</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>Bradley H. Jones, Jr.</i>	<i>20th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/29/2025</i>

SENATE No. 2500

By Mr. Velis, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 2500) of John C. Velis, Hannah Kane and Bradley H. Jones, Jr. for legislation relative to recognition of the "Honor and Remember" flag in the Commonwealth. Veterans and Federal Affairs.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 2357 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to recognition of the "Honor and Remember" flag in the Commonwealth.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 2 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the following section:-

2 Section 64. (a) The Honor and Remember Flag created by Honor and Remember, Inc.
3 shall be designated as the symbol of the Commonwealth's concern and commitment to honoring
4 and remembering the lives of all members of the United States Armed Forces who have lost their
5 lives while serving, or as a result of service, and their families. The Honor and Remember Flag's
6 red field shall represent the blood shed by brave men and women who sacrificed their lives for
7 freedom; the Flag's white field and border shall recognize the purity of that sacrifice; the Flag's
8 blue star shall be a symbol of the active service in military conflicts that dates back to World
9 War I; the Flag's gold star shall signify the ultimate sacrifice of a warrior in active service who
10 will not return home and shall reflect the value of the life given; the folded Flag shall highlight

11 this nation's final tribute to a fallen service member and a family's sacrifice; and the Flag's
12 flame shall symbolize the eternal spirit of the departed. The Flag shall be a unifying symbol
13 recognizing this nation's solemn debt to the estimated 1.6 million fallen service members
14 throughout history and the families and communities who mourn their loss.

15 (b) When flown on the same pole or pole formation as other flags, The Honor and
16 Remember flag shall be flown beneath any American Flag, flag of the Commonwealth, or
17 Prisoners of War/Missing in Action flag that may also be flown on said pole or formation. The
18 Honor and Remember flag shall never be larger than the American flag flown on the same pole
19 or in the same formation of poles.

20 (c) The Honor and Remember Flag should be in good condition if flown, free from rips,
21 stains, or significant fading.

22 (d) The Honor and Remember Flag shall be displayed by those wishing to honor and
23 remember the lives of all members of the United States Armed Forces who have lost their lives
24 while serving, or as a result of service, and their families on the following days:

25 (1) Armed Forces Day, the third Saturday in May;

26 (2) Memorial Day, the last Monday in May;

27 (3) Flag Day, June 14;

28 (4) The Fourth of July;

29 (5) National POW/MIA Recognition Day;

30 (6) Veterans Day, November 11;

- 31 (7) Gold Star Mother's Day, the last Sunday of September; and
- 32 (8) Whenever there is a military casualty in the Commonwealth.
- 33 (e) Nothing in this act shall be interpreted as a mandate to purchase or display an Honor
- 34 and Remember flag by any individual, organization, municipality, or agency.